

SYNC ME

Producer Notes — Tempo, Key, Chords & Arrangement

Three treatments of the same song, sharing one chord skeleton (A minor, relative C major) so a player can move between them without relearning the tune. Each section below covers tempo, key, chords, and the production choices that make that version's identity legible on first listen.

1. ORIGINAL — Cyber-noir / dream-pop electronic

TEMPO

96 BPM, straight 4/4. Half-time feel under the chorus (kick/snare drop to 2 and 4 at half speed while the synth pulse keeps 96).

KEY

A minor, lifting to its relative C major at the chorus lift on “chrome moon.”

CHORDS

Verse: Am – F – C – G (i – VI – III – VII), looped.

Pre-chorus: same progression, bass climbs chromatically Am–B $\blacksquare$ –B–C to build tension into the chorus.

Chorus: Am – G – F – C, brighter voicing (add9s) to sell the “chrome moon” lift.

Bridge: strip to Am pedal with no chord movement — the vocal carries the harmony alone.

PRODUCTION

- Verse: sparse — vocal, pulsing sidechained synth pad, minimal four-on-floor kick, no snare yet.
 - Pre-chorus: rising arpeggio (16th-note sequence) layered under the chromatic bass climb; a white-noise riser enters in the last two bars.
 - Chorus: full four-on-floor kick, layered synth stabs on the backbeat, big gated reverb on the vocal, sub bass under “strike the core.”
 - Bridge: drop everything but vocal + drone pad + occasional glitch-stutter edit on the vocal tail (echoes the clinical, edited quality of the Ledger voiceover) — this should sound like a recording being reviewed, not performed.
 - Final chorus: double the lead vocal an octave up, add a choir-like synth pad underneath.
 - Outro: tape-stop / pitch-down effect on the last “sync me,” cutting to silence rather than fading.
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2. LEMURIA REWRITE — submerged ritual variant

TEMPO

Same 96 BPM skeleton, but felt slower — pull the pulse back with heavy sidechain release and reverb pre-delay so the tempo reads as underwater drift rather than a driving 96.

KEY

Same A minor / C major, all pads detuned –15 to –25 cents for the underwater-wobble effect.

CHORDS

Identical progressions to the Original — do not change the harmony, only the sound design. The mythology lives in the arrangement, not the chords.

PRODUCTION

- Replace glitch percussion with water-hit / dripping samples (pitched to the chord tones so they read as instrumentation, not sound effects).
 - Replace the white-noise pre-chorus riser with a reversed-reverb swell.
 - Add a low sub-rumble (hydrophone-style, 40–60Hz) sitting under the whole track — should be felt more than heard.
 - Bridge: add a wordless choir/drone layer underneath the vocal, run through a long, dark convolution reverb (think a chant filtered through deep water) — this is the Catcher's collective Ledger, audible for the first time.
 - Outro: instead of a tape-stop, pitch the last “sync me” down and slow it as it fades, like sinking rather than cutting off.
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3. STRIPPED BALLAD — genre pass, same lyrics

TEMPO

68 BPM, rubato — let the vocal lead the time, don't lock to a click past the scratch take.

KEY

Same key center (A minor / C major), but voice-led triads instead of the electronic version's stacked add9 chords — simpler, more exposed.

CHORDS

Verse/Chorus: Am – F – C – G, played as simple arpeggiated piano or fingerpicked guitar — no loop-driven repetition, let each chord breathe.

Bridge: Am – Em – F – C, a slight harmonic detour from the electronic version's static pedal, to give the strings somewhere to go when they enter.

PRODUCTION

- Solo piano or acoustic guitar carries the whole song; strings enter only under the second half of Verse 2 and swell fully in the Bridge.
 - Vocal recorded dry and close — no big reverb until the final chorus.
 - See the Lyric Book's ballad arrangement map for the section-by-section cut (second pre-chorus removed, everything else full length).
 - Outro: a cappella or voice over a single sustained piano note, ending in real silence — no reverb tail.
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Suggested runtimes: Original ~3:40 (full structure as written). Lemuria Rewrite ~3:50 (same structure, slower felt tempo). Stripped Ballad ~2:50 (one pre-chorus cut, per the arrangement map).